



Alberta Public Health Disease Management Guidelines

Bacillus Cereus



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Alberta Health

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Contents

Case Definition	4
Confirmed Case	4
Probable Case	4
Reporting Requirements	5
Laboratories	5
Alberta Health Services and First Nations and Inuit Health Branch	5
Appendix 1: Revision History	6

Case Definition

Confirmed Case

Clinical illness^(A) with laboratory confirmation of infection:

- Isolation of $\geq 10^5$ *Bacillus cereus* organisms per gram^(B) from the stool or epidemiologically implicated food.^(C)

Probable Case (Outbreak Only)

Clinical illness^(A) in a person who is epidemiologically linked to a confirmed case.

^(A) Clinical illness is characterized in some cases by the sudden onset of nausea and vomiting, and in others by abdominal cramps and diarrhea.

^(B) Isolation of *B.cereus* in numbers less the 10^5 organisms per gram may be indicative of normal flora only and not necessarily the causative agent.

^(C) Refer to the [Provincial Laboratory for Public Health \(ProvLab\) Guide to Services](#) for current specimen collection and submission information.

Reporting Requirements

Laboratories

All laboratories shall report all positive laboratory results by mail, fax or electronic transfer within 48 hours (two business days) to the:

- Chief Medical Officer of Health (or designate), and
- Medical Officer of Health (or designate) of the zone.

Alberta Health Services and First Nations and Inuit Health Branch

- Report outbreaks only using the [Alberta Outbreak Report Form](#).
- Completion of a Notifiable Disease Report is not required.

Appendix 1: Revision History

Revision Date	Document Section	Description of Revision
October 2021	General	• Updated Template • Added web link for Outbreak Reporting Form
	Case Definition	• “Outbreak Only” added to Probable Case definition heading as only applies in outbreak setting for public health reporting.